Moving to Your New Chromebook

A step-by-step guide, written for Tria at Ideal Organizing + Design

Most of what you use already lives in your Google account, so it will appear on the new Chromebook as soon as you sign in. That includes Gmail, Google Drive, your bookmarks, saved passwords and settings. The one thing that needs your help is any file saved only on the old Chromebook itself. This guide walks you through finding those files, copying them into your Google Drive, and checking that they arrived.

Plan on about 30 minutes, plus some waiting while files upload. Nothing here erases anything. Every step copies, so your old Chromebook stays exactly as it is.

BEFORE YOU START

- ☐ Both Chromebooks charged and plugged in
- ☐ A working Wi-Fi connection
- ☐ Your Google account email and password (the one you sign into the old Chromebook with)
- ☐ Your phone nearby, in case Google sends a sign-in code

TWO CHROMEBOOK BASICS

- **Right-click:** tap the touchpad with two fingers at the same time. That opens the menu with Copy, Paste and New folder.
- **The Files app:** click the circle in the bottom-left corner of the screen, type **Files**, and press Enter.

PART 1 Find the files saved on the old Chromebook

Do this on the old Chromebook.

1. **Open the Files app.**
   Click the circle in the bottom-left corner, type **Files**, and press Enter.
2. **Click “My files” in the left-hand column.**
   Everything under My files is stored only on this Chromebook. The most important folder is **Downloads**, which is where email attachments, saved PDFs and screenshots usually land. Click it and look at what is there.
3. **Check the other folders under My files.**
   You may also see folders such as **Play files** (from Android apps) or **Linux files**. If either one holds files you want to keep, make a note of it. If you don’t see them, that’s fine.

4. **Find Google Drive in the same left-hand column.**
   Below My files you'll see **Google Drive**, with **My Drive** inside it. Anything already in there is safe and will show up on the new Chromebook on its own.

PART 2 Copy those files into Google Drive

Still on the old Chromebook.

5. **Make a new folder in My Drive.**
   Click **My Drive**. Right-click on an empty white area, choose **New folder**, name it **From old Chromebook**, and press Enter. (The shortcut is `ctrl` + `e`.)
6. **Go back to My files → Downloads and select the files.**
   To select everything in the folder, press `ctrl` + `a`. To pick only some, hold `ctrl` and click each one.
7. **Copy them.**
   Right-click on one of the selected files and choose **Copy**, or press `ctrl` + `c`. Please use Copy, never Cut or Move, so the originals stay put until you've checked the new machine.
8. **Paste them into your new folder.**
   Open **My Drive → From old Chromebook**, right-click on an empty area, and choose **Paste**, or press `ctrl` + `v`.
9. **Wait for the upload to finish.**
   A progress message appears in the bottom-right corner of the screen. Leave the Chromebook open, plugged in, and on Wi-Fi until it says it's done. A lot of files can take a while, and that's normal.
10. **Repeat for any other folder you noted in step 3.**
    Copy and paste each one into **From old Chromebook** the same way.
11. **Double-check that everything arrived.**
    Open the Chrome browser and go to **drive.google.com**. Open the **From old Chromebook** folder and make sure your files are listed there.

PART 3 Set up the new Chromebook

Now switch to the new Chromebook.

12. **Turn it on and connect to Wi-Fi.**
    Follow the setup screens.
13. **Sign in with the same Google account.**
    Use exactly the same email address you use on the old Chromebook. If Google sends a code to your phone, enter it.

14 **Say yes to syncing.**
If setup asks whether to sync your settings, or to restore apps from your previous Chromebook, choose yes.

15 **Give it 10 to 15 minutes.**
Your bookmarks, apps and settings fill in on their own in the background.

16 **Open your files.**
Open the Files app, click **Google Drive → My Drive → From old Chromebook**, and open two or three files to make sure they look right.

PART 4 Check before you retire the old one

- [ ] My files open on the new Chromebook
- [ ] Gmail and Google Drive look the way they always do
- [ ] My bookmarks are in Chrome
- [ ] Websites I log into still remember my passwords
- [ ] The apps I use every day are installed

Keep the old Chromebook just as it is for a couple of weeks. Please don't reset or erase it (Chromebooks call this **Powerwash**) until we've talked, so there's always a way back if something turns up missing.

> **STOP AND REACH OUT IF**
>
> - Any screen asks you to erase, reset or Powerwash.
> - You see an error message, or a message that your Google storage is full.
> - The upload hasn't moved for a long time.
> - Something just doesn't look right.
>
> Take a photo of the screen with your phone and send it to me. We can finish the rest together on a short video call, where you share your screen and I walk you through it.

> **ABOUT YOUR FILES**
>
> Everything in this guide stays inside your own Google account. Your files move from the old Chromebook into your own Google Drive, and nothing goes to us or to any new service.